

Bell applies for extension

By Jeff Maguire,
Special to The Gazette

If enough area residents are interested and necessary approvals are received Bell Canada customers in Carleton Place, Almonte and Pakenham may be able to call Ottawa-Carleton Region exchanges without a long distance charge perhaps as early as next January 1.

In November of last year Bell made an application to the Canadian Radio Television and Telecommunications Commission (CRTC) requesting that the commission relax the criteria for extended area telephone service. A total of 190 locations in Ontario and Quebec are involved in the application, mainly communities within close proximity to large urban centres (Ottawa included) where Bell customers are presently forced to pay long distance charges, despite the fact they are relatively close to the centres involved.

Linda Terrill, Bell's district manager for Ontario East, said Friday that Bell is presently awaiting word from the CRTC on the application. "We asked for a decision by February 1 (1986) but there is no guarantee we will get that," Mrs Terrill noted.

She added that until the initial application is approved, no further steps can be taken to offer the service to residents.

Terrill said that should the application receive approval, the next step would be for Bell to outline the specific detail of the proposal as well as survey residents of the communities involved to determine interest in such a move.

"We hope to file (the formal application) by the middle of the year," she commented.

In Lanark County residents on the 257 (Carleton Place), 256 (Almonte) and 624 (Pakenham) exchanges are involved in the proposal. They, along

with residents of all the communities involved, will be surveyed to determine interest in the plan.

Terrill said 50 per cent or more must approve of the service before it can be extended to an area.

She continued, saying the proposal is part of a six year plan by Bell Canada and that even with acceptance by the CRTC and residents, the earliest possible date for implementation in the Lanark communities is January 1, 1987. She is hopeful that will occur, but said it could take much longer, depending on the approval process.

As to the additional cost for the extended service, Terrill noted that the present monthly service charge would increase an average \$2 per month. But callers in the three Lanark communities would have access to all of the Ottawa exchanges and phones around the capital region in such communities as Nepean, Kanata, Stittsville, Richmond, Munster Hamlet etc without having to pay long distance charges.

"They (residents) will have access to all of the Ottawa area exchanges if the program is approved," Terrill confirmed.

The present situation creates some extremely unusual situations, because of the imaginary lines created by municipal boundaries. For example, residents of the Village of Ashton have, for many years, lobbied unsuccessfully for removal of long distance charges which presently apply, in a few cases, to neighboring homes and businesses. Ashton is bisected by the Lanark-Ottawa Carleton line. So residents in the community are, in most cases, on the Carleton Place (257) telephone exchange. Others in that vicinity, however, are served by an exchange in the Ottawa-Carleton Region which sets the strange scenario of close neighbors being forced to call long distance to one another.

On a more serious note, the situation has also created confusion when residents must make emergency calls.

Fire, police and ambulance calls by Ashton residents are directed to Stittsville, Kanata and Ottawa respectively and many residents must call long distance. In the case of fire, for example, residents often call the nearby Beckwith Township Fire Department in Lanark County whose phone is also on the Carleton Place (257) exchange, creating confusion when the dispatcher informs them they should be calling the Goulbourn Township Fire Department's Stittsville Station.

The latest Bell proposal would be especially pleasing to residents of Ashton and area who do much of their business in the Ottawa-Carleton Region.

Terrill discounted, as misinformation, previous stories that indicated the service will begin this year and that callers would only have access to exchanges in Ottawa proper and not phones in other Ottawa-Carleton centres.

Present CRTC regulations state that exchanges must be adjoining or share part of a telephone exchange boundary and not be more than 30 miles apart.

Bell hopes the CRTC will eliminate the criterion that exchanges must be adjoining and base the area of extended service on evolving customer calling patterns.

Terrill agreed that there is much interest in communities such as Carleton Place and Almonte in receiving the extended service, because of the close proximity of the municipalities to the Ottawa-Carleton Region.

She said customers should know soon whether extended service is a possibility, but noted the move is entirely contingent on CRTC approval.

New Year brings storm to White Lake

The new year has brought a stormy week with snow, which has been a very welcome sight for the many snowmobilers and ski enthusiasts in the community.

Recent visitors in the community included Mr and Mrs Jim Deslauriers of Mattawa with Grace Cameron and Mr and Mrs Wm McLachlan.

Mr and Mrs Gordon McLellan, Curtis and Ashley of Kingston were holiday visitors with Lois McLellan and other friends in the community.

Recent visitors with Luella Campbell included Mr and Mrs Hal Campbell and Matthew of Toronto, Mr and Mrs John Grassford and Lauren of Ingersoll, Mr and Mrs Jerry Sadler of Ottawa, Mr and Mrs Cyril Bolger of Ottawa.

John Fraser is convalescing at home after being a patient in hospital. Best wishes for continued improvement. Congratulations to Charlie and Marie McCourt on their 31 wedding anniversary on January 3.

Sympathy is extended to the Cinkant family in the death of Mr Coleman Cinkant. Burial was in Ottawa.

Get well wishes to Nan Campbell who was in hospital last week.

Jim McManus is convalescing at home after being a hospital patient.

Get well wishes to Waveney Campbell who is apatient in hospital and to Vina Barrie who has returned home from hospital. Joanne Baker of Kingston

was a weekend visitor with her mother Rosy Baker and other friends. Cathy McEwan of Ottawa spent several days recently

with her parents Mr and Mrs Mel McEwan and other friends in the district. Wm McLachlan made a business trip to the states this

week. Mrs Lil Yull of Chelms was a recent visitor with Mr and Mrs Gilbert Fraser and other friends in the village.

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Syrup producers meeting is scheduled in Lanark Jan 14

The Lanark and District Maple Syrup Producers' Association will meet Jan 14 at the Shaky Maple Restaurant in Lanark, for its 20th annual Information Day meeting.

The meeting will commence at 2 pm and consists of an afternoon and evening session, with a buffet dinner at the Shaky Maple Restaurant which will be available at 5:30 pm.

Last season was the first time mandatory grading regulations for maple syrup were in effect in Ontario. All maple syrup sold in the province must be graded.

In the afternoon session, Ken Sills, district supervisor for the fruit and vegetable inspection branch of the Ontario Ministry of Agriculture and Food, will attend to discuss the importance of quality control in the production of high quality maple syrup. Promoting the production and sale of top quality maple syrup is a major objective of the association.

Clarence Coons, agro-forestry co-ordinator with the Ontario Ministry of Agriculture and Food, will discuss improving sap production from the sugar bush. Milt Stewart, private land forestry technician with the Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources at Carleton Place, will discuss sugar bush management projects in the area.

In the evening, Bill Langenberg of the Kemptville College of Agricultural Technology, will speak on the results of the research on the Raithby Economizer tested at the college. Also, Alec Denys, gypsy moth program co-ordinator for the Ontario ministry of natural resources at Tweed, will discuss the current status of gypsy moth in Eastern Ontario. Later in the evening Marion Paul will discuss exhibiting maple products at the Royal Winter Fair.

Planning grant awarded

A community planning grant of \$5,000 has been awarded to the Town of Perth, Bernard Grandmaitre, minister of municipal affairs, has announced today.

Mr Grandmaitre said the grant will be used to develop community improvement policies for the town.

Community planning grants are designed to encourage municipalities to

resolve land use planning issues to reflect municipal and economic priorities.

The grants may also be used for special studies to develop community improvement policies; to determine the feasibility of using data processing technology in the local planning process, and to assist in implementing the Planning Act.

Almonte Basketball Association

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9:00 a.m. to 9:00 p.m.



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Open Monday to Friday 9:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.
Saturday 9:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m.